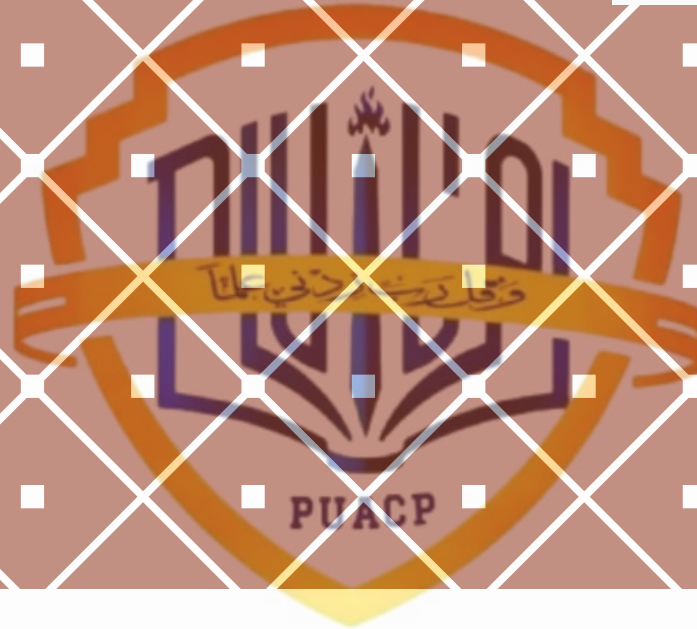




LECTURE 9

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QUESTIONNAIRE DESIGNING

QUESTIONNAIRE

- ❖ Questionnaire is an instrument consists of series of statements/questions that are submitted to the respondents for collecting data.
- ❖ Respondent read the questions, interpret what is expected and then write down the answers himself.

QUESTIONNAIRE

- ❖ Questionnaire construction is more of an art than a science.
- ❖ It takes skill, practice, patience and creativity.
- ❖ Questionnaire serves as an appropriate and reliable data gathering instrument.
- ❖ Questionnaire can be used to investigate any topic by obtaining factual information.

STEPS OF WRITING QUESTIONNAIRE

There is a sequence of some logical steps to develop a good questionnaire.

1. Make a plan about what to measure.
2. Formulate the questionnaire in the context of required information.
3. Make a layout and wording of questions.
4. For omissions & ambiguity take a small sample to test the questionnaire.
5. correct the problems if they are.

ART OF WRITING GOOD QUESTIONNAIRE

- ❖ A good questionnaire is the one which is specifically designed with set objectives in mind.
- ❖ A questionnaire should be relevant to the purpose to obtain the required data.
- ❖ For inclusion in the questionnaire, each question should have a clear logic.
- ❖ A good questionnaire accomplishes the researcher's objectives.
- ❖ the layout of the questions should be such that it is easy to read and pleasant to the eye.
- ❖ The sequence of questions should be easy to follow.

ART OF WRITING GOOD QUESTIONNAIRE

- ❖ A good questionnaire should be developed in an interactive style. This means that respondents should feel as someone is talking to them.
- ❖ As there is no one to explain the meanings of the questions to respondents so it is important that questions are clear and easy to understand.
- ❖ The difficult and sensitive questions should place at the end.
- ❖ Use simple language and avoid ambiguous words.
- ❖ The options of each questions should be mutually exclusive & exhaustive.

WAYS OF ADMINISTERING QUESTIONNAIRE

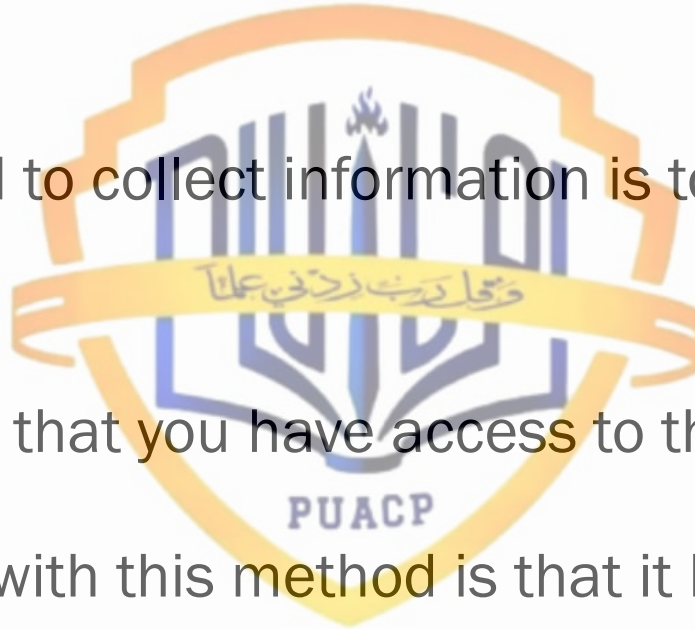
A questionnaire may be administered in different ways.

- ❖ The mailed questionnaire.
- ❖ Collective administration.
- ❖ Administration in a public place



MAILED QUESTIONNAIRE

- ❖ The most common method to collect information is to send the questionnaire to the respondents by mail.
- ❖ This approach presuppose that you have access to their addresses.
- ❖ One of the major problem with this method is that it has very low response rate.
- ❖ With extremely low response rate, the findings have very limited applicability to the population studied.



COLLECTIVE ADMINISTRATION

- ❖ One of the best way of administering the questionnaire is to obtain a captive audience assembled in one place such as students in class room or people attending a function.
- ❖ This ensures a very high response rate.
- ❖ Also you have personal contact so you can explain the purpose and importance of the study and can clarify any questions that respondent may require.
- ❖ It is a very quick way of collecting data which saves a lot of money.

ADMINISTRATION IN A PUBLIC PLACE

- ❖ Sometimes you can administer a questionnaire in a public place such as shopping mall, health center, hospital or school.
- ❖ Usually the purpose of the study is explained to the potential respondents and they approach and their participation is requested.
- ❖ This method has all the advantages of administering a questionnaire collectively except it is more time consuming.

ADVANTAGES OF QUESTIONNAIRE OVER INTERVIEWS

A questionnaire has several advantages.

Economic: As you do not interview respondent so you saves time, human and financial resources. It is extremely inexpensive method to collect data when it is administered collectively to a study population.

Secrecy: As there is no face to face interaction between respondent and interviewer, this method gives greater privacy. In some situation where sensitive questions are asked it helps to increase the likelihood of obtaining accurate information.

DISADVANTAGES OF QUESTIONNAIRE

Limited Application: A questionnaire has limited application to the study population that can read and write.

Low Response Rate: most of the time people fail to return them.

Self Selection Bias: when the response rate is very low the finding may not be representative of the entire study population, which causes selection bias.

Lack of clarification: for any reason, respondent may not understand some questions. Also different respondents interpret questions differently which affect the quality of information.

Spontaneous Response not allowed: A questionnaire allows time to respondents to reflect before answering so it is not possible to record sudden responses if required.

DISADVANTAGES OF QUESTIONNAIRE

Possible to consult others: with mailed questionnaires, respondents may consult other people before responding. This becomes inappropriate if researcher wishes to know the respondents own opinion.

Influenced by other questions: As respondent can read all the questions before answering so his response may be affected by his knowledge of other questions.

TYPES OF QUESTIONS

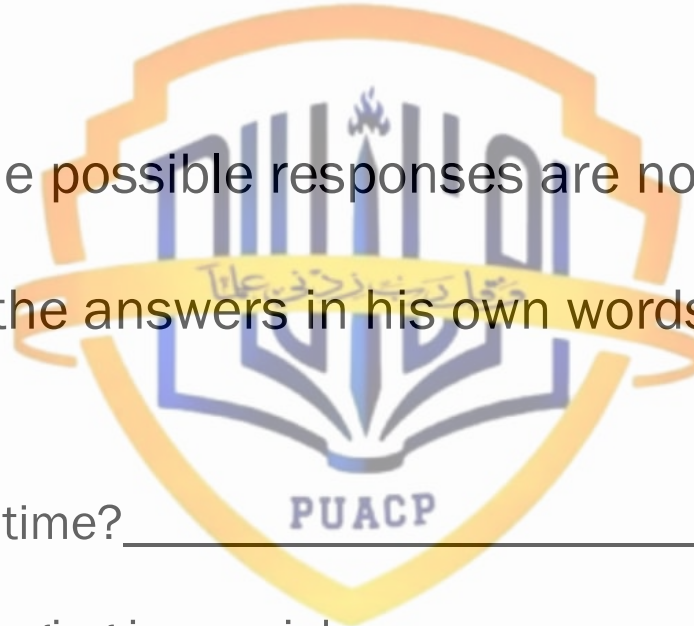
- ❖ The form and wording of questions used in an interview or a questionnaire are extremely important in a research instrument as they have an effect on the type and quality of information obtained from a respondent.
 - ❖ let us discuss different forms of questions, which are commonly used in social sciences research
1. Open-Ended Questions
 2. Closed-Ended Questions
 3. Hybrid Questions.

OPEN-ENDED QUESTIONS

- ❖ In an open-ended question the possible responses are not given.
- ❖ The respondent writes down the answers in his own words.

For example

- ❖ What you like to do in your spare time? _____
- ❖ State three things that are challenging in your job. _____
- ❖ What you like about your college? _____
- ❖ Open ended questions can be used in interviews as well as questionnaires.



CLOSED-ENDED QUESTIONS

- ❖ In a closed question the possible answers are set out in the questionnaire.
- ❖ Closed-ended questions have short check mark responses.
- ❖ There is no provision other than the given answers for the respondent.
- ❖ the respondent or the investigator ticks the category that best describes the respondent's answer.
- ❖ Closed-questions can also be used in interviews as well as questionnaires.

- ❖ These are widely used types of questions.
- ❖ These may also known as multiple choice questions.

For example

- ❖ What is your designation?

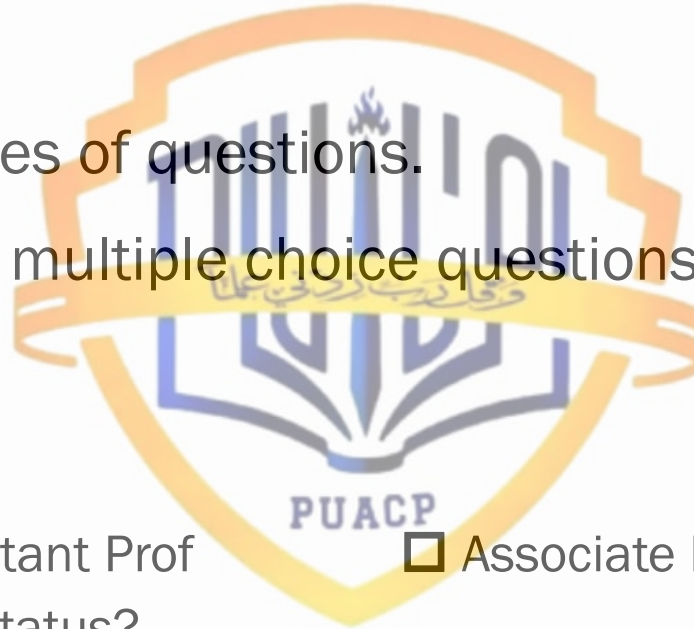
☐ Lecturer ☐ Assistant Prof ☐ Associate Prof ☐ Professor

- ❖ What is your socio economic status?

☐ upper class ☐ Upper Middle Class ☐ Lower Middle Class ☐ Poor

- ❖ Government education policy is in right direction?

☐ Strongly disagree ☐ Disagree ☐ Undecided ☐ Agree ☐ Strongly Agree



HYBRID QUESTIONS

❖ The combination of open-ended and closed-ended question is called a hybrid question

For example

❖ Which sport you like the most?

☐ Cricket ☐ Football ☐ Hockey ☐ Badminton ☐ other(specify)_____



ADVANTAGES OF OPEN-ENDED QUESTIONS

- ❖ Open-ended questions provide greater depth of response.
- ❖ If respondents are fluent in the language used and feel comfortable about expressing their opinions then open-ended questions can provide in-depth information.
- ❖ open-ended questions provide respondents with the opportunity to express themselves freely, resulting in a greater variety of information
- ❖ As open-ended questions eliminate the possibility of investigator bias (investigator bias is introduced through the response pattern presented to respondents).

DISADVANTAGES OF OPEN-ENDED QUESTIONS

- ❖ These are difficult to tabulate, summarize, analyze and interpret,
- ❖ The researcher usually needs to go through another process – content analysis – in order to classify the data.
- ❖ in a questionnaire, some respondents may not be able to express themselves, and so information can be lost.
- ❖ There is a greater chance of interviewer bias in open-ended questions.
- ❖ Open ended questions requires great effort on the part of respondent as well as researcher.

ADVANTAGES OF CLOSED-ENDED QUESTIONS

- ❖ These are easy to fill out and analyze.
- ❖ Close-ended questions provides the relevant information only.
- ❖ These do not require much time.
- ❖ These are more acceptable for the respondent.
- ❖ These are popular because these provide a greater uniformity of responses.
- ❖ These are easy to tabulate, summaries, analyze and interpret,

DISADVANTAGES OF CLOSED-ENDED QUESTIONS

- ❖ One of the main disadvantages of closed questions is that the information obtained through them lacks depth and variety.
- ❖ There is a greater possibility of investigator bias because the researcher may list only the response patterns that he is interested in or those that come to mind.
- ❖ The ease of answering a ready-made list of responses may create a tendency among some respondents and interviewers to tick a category or categories without thinking through the issue.

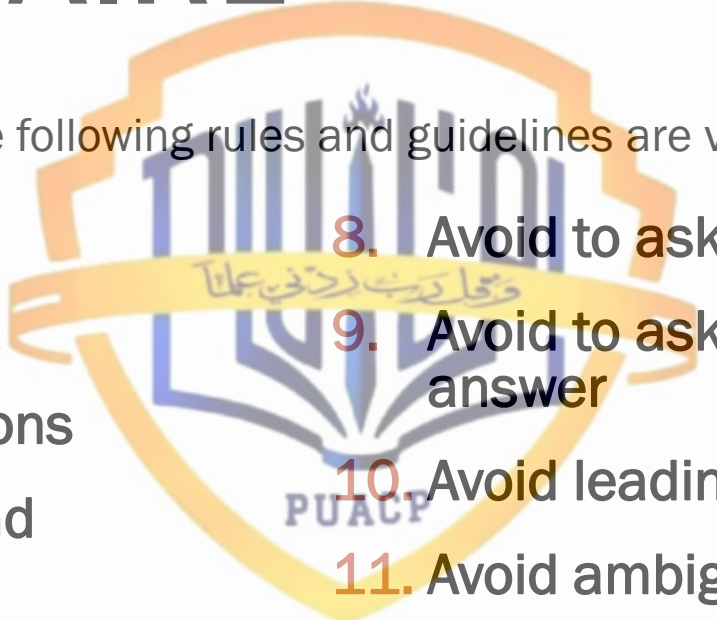
DISADVANTAGES OF CLOSED-ENDED QUESTIONS

- ❖ In a questionnaire, the given response pattern for a question could condition the thinking of respondents, and so the answers provided may not truly reflect respondents' opinions. Rather, they may reflect the extent of agreement or disagreement with the researcher's opinion or analysis of a situation.



GUIDELINES FOR WRITING GOOD QUESTIONNAIRE

To write a good questionnaire the following rules and guidelines are very useful and important.

- 
1. Make short items
 2. Questions should be relevant
 3. Avoid double barreled questions
 4. Avoid to use terminologies and abbreviation
 5. Avoid Biased items and Terms
 6. Positively and negatively worded questions
 7. Avoid excessive use of Not and Only
 8. Avoid to ask beyond respondent ability
 9. Avoid to ask respondent is unwilling to answer
 10. Avoid leading questions
 11. Avoid ambiguities and vagueness
 12. Avoid questions based on presumptions
 13. Avoid asking about future intentions
 14. Avoid emotional language

MAKE SHORT ITEMS

- ❖ Try to keep the survey short.
- ❖ Provide clear and short statements that will not be misinterpreted.
- ❖ Avoid long and complicated questions.
- ❖ Respondent must be able to read an item quickly.
- ❖ As a rule of thumb, try to keep the number of question from 30 to 50.



QUESTIONS SHOULD BE RELEVANT

- ❖ The question should be relevant to most respondents.
- ❖ Researcher should consider the respondent's possessions of information while asking for his opinion.
- ❖ Do not ask for an opinion for which respondent is not capable of.

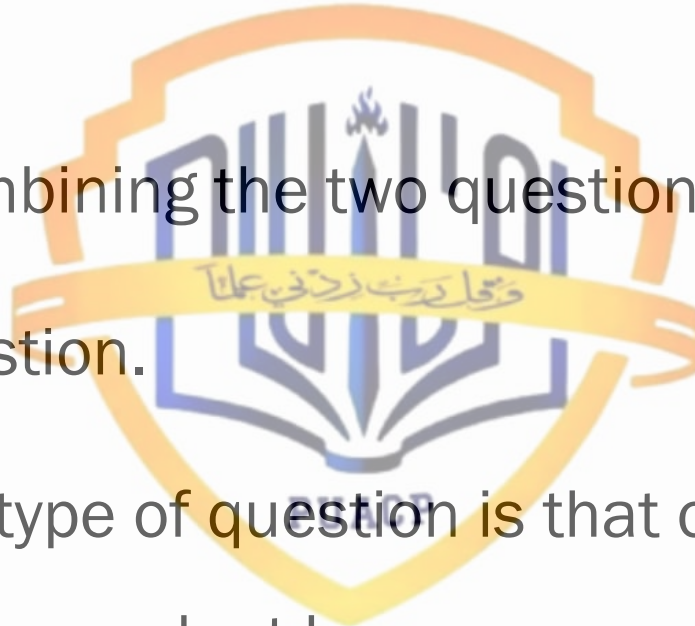
For example

- ❖ an ordinary mobile user is not qualified to offer opinion about computer hardware.



AVOID DOUBLE BARRELED QUESTIONS

- ❖ Double-Barreled means combining the two questions in one question.
- ❖ It is a question within a question.
- ❖ The main problem with this type of question is that one does not know which particular question a respondent has answered.
- ❖ Always avoid asking Double-Barreled questions.



AVOID DOUBLE BARRELED QUESTIONS

❖ Generally when the word “and” appears in a question, you should check whether you are asking a double Barreled question.

For Example

- ❖ How often and how much time do you spend on each visit in market?
- ❖ Do you use smart phone and for what purpose you like to use it?
- ❖ What is your monthly income and how you spend it?



AVOID TO USE TERMINOLOGIES AND ABBREVIATION

- ❖ Your respondents may not be highly educated, and even if they are they still may not know some of the 'simple' technical terminology that you are used to.
- ❖ Try to avoid the use of difficult terminologies, unnecessary technical words and abbreviations.

For example

- ❖ Is anyone in your family a dipsomaniac?
- ❖ Instead to writing "UNO" write United Nation Organization

AVOID BIASED ITEMS AND TERMS

- ❖ The questions that encourage respondents to answer in a particular way are called biased questions.
- ❖ The wording of the question effect the meaning of someone's response to a question in large part.
- ❖ Question should be unbiased.
- ❖ By adding the following categories in sensitive questions we can avoid or minimize the biasedness.
 - ❖ Don't know (DK), Not Applicable (NA), No Response (NR)

POSITIVELY AND NEGATIVELY WORDED QUESTIONS

- ❖ A questionnaire should include both positively and negatively worded questions.
- ❖ The tendency in respondents to mechanically circle the points towards one end of the scale will be minimized by including some negatively worded questions in the questionnaire
- ❖ A respondent is more likely to stay alert while answering the questions when both positive and negative worded questions are used.
- ❖ Questions should be designed in such a way so that respondent may circle on both parts of questions Yes and No

For example.

❖ Did your parent attend college? ☐ Yes ☐ No

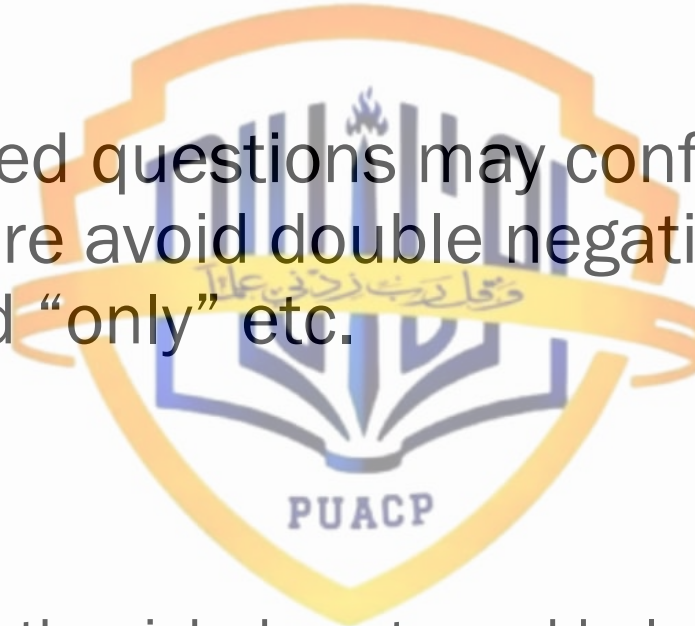
❖ Is your mother employed? ☐ Yes ☐ No

AVOID EXCESSIVE USE OF NOT AND ONLY

- ❖ The negatively worded questions may confuse the respondents, therefore avoid double negatives and excessive use of word “Not” and “only” etc.

For example

- ❖ instead of saying “Only the rich do not need help”
- ❖ Say “The rich need no help”



AVOID TO ASK BEYOND RESPONDENT ABILITY

- ❖ Do not ask anything beyond the respondent's ability.
- ❖ Do not ask questions for which respondents could not respond properly.
- ❖ Avoid to ask short memory questions from the respondents.

For example

- ❖ How many times do you have filled fuel in your bike in last month?
- ❖ What was your monthly consumption in the year?

AVOID TO ASK RESPONDENT IS UNWILLING TO ANSWER

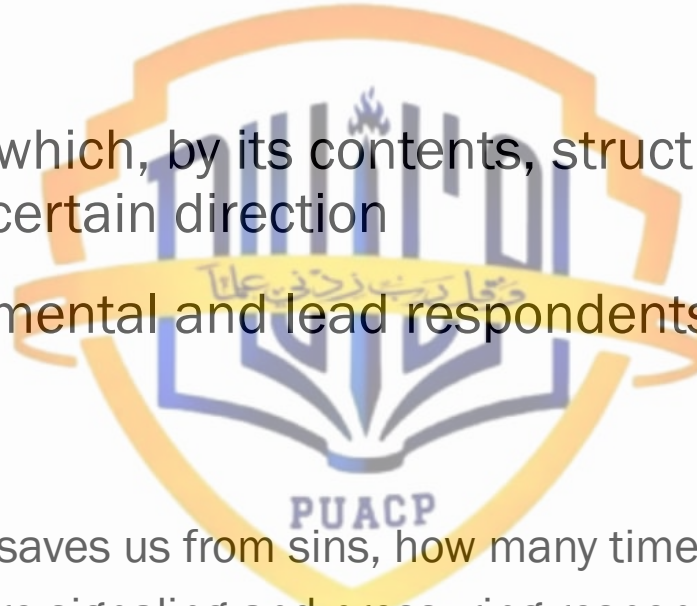
- ❖ Sometimes respondents are unwilling and reluctant to tell what the opinion is.
- ❖ Do not ask directly for information the respondent is not like to share willingly.
- ❖ There may many situations when respondent do not like to produce accurate information.
- ❖ A correct answer which is socially unacceptable, respondent may unwilling to answer that question.

For example

- ❖ Question on income, charities, religious views, sect, cast, price paid for an article etc.

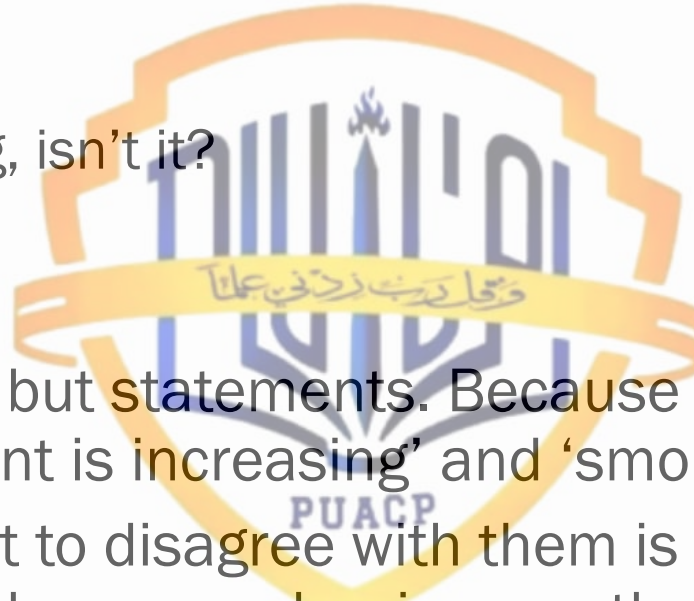
AVOID LEADING QUESTIONS

- ❖ A leading question is one which, by its contents, structure or wording, leads a respondent to answer in a certain direction
- ❖ Such questions are judgemental and lead respondents to answer either positively or negatively.
- ❖ For example
 - ❖ Offering prayer is good thing it saves us from sins, how many times do you pray in a day?
 - ❖ By asking such questions we are signaling and pressuring respondent to say Yes
- ❖ Don't you think that employees should be given good pay raises, due to rising inflation?
- ❖ Tagging the question to rising inflation make it difficult for most people to say No



MORE EXAMPLES

- ❖ Unemployment is increasing, isn't it?
- ❖ Smoking is bad, isn't it?
- ❖ . These are not questions but statements. Because the statements suggest that 'unemployment is increasing' and 'smoking is bad',
- ❖ respondents may feel that to disagree with them is to be in the wrong, especially if they feel that the researcher is an authority and that if he is saying that 'unemployment is increasing' or 'smoking is bad',
- ❖ The feeling that there is a 'right' answer can 'force' people to respond in a way that is contrary to their true position.



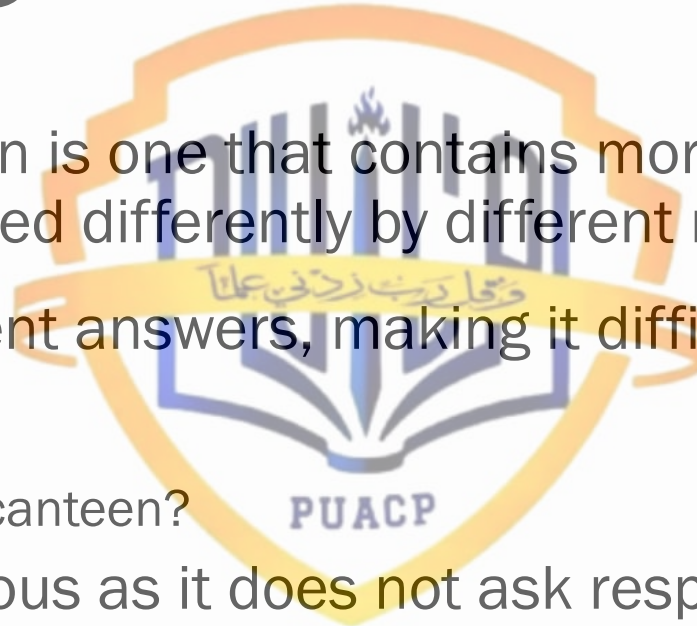
AVOID AMBIGUITIES AND VAGUENESS

- ❖ . An ambiguous question is one that contains more than one meaning and that can be interpreted differently by different respondents.
- ❖ This will result in different answers, making it difficult.

For example

- ❖ Are you satisfied with your canteen?
- ❖ Questions are ambiguous as it does not ask respondents to indicate the aspects of the canteen with which they may be satisfied or dissatisfied. Is it with the service, the prices, the physical facilities, the attitude of the staff or the quality of the meals?

Right question should be 'Are you, on the whole, satisfied with your canteen?'

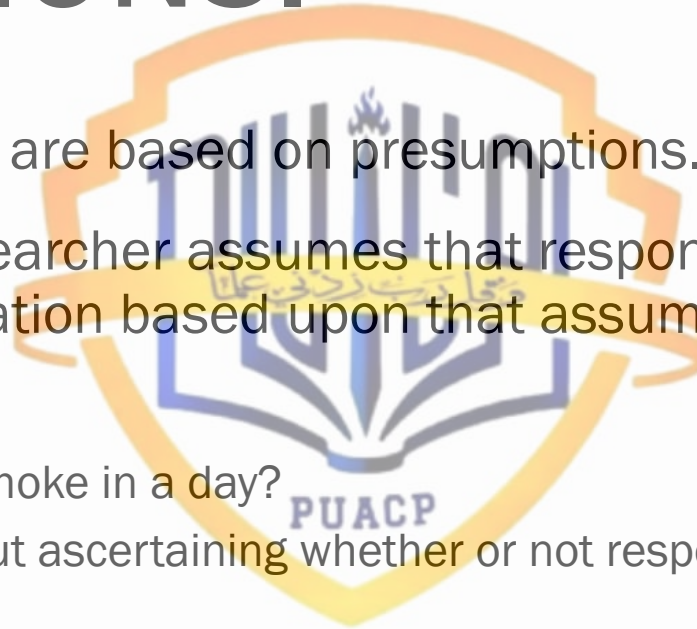


AVOID QUESTIONS BASED ON PRESUMPTIONS.

- ❖ Do not ask questions that are based on presumptions.
- ❖ In such questions the researcher assumes that respondents fit into a particular category and seeks information based upon that assumption.

For example

- ❖ How many cigarettes do you smoke in a day?
- ❖ The question was asked without ascertaining whether or not respondents were smokers or not.
- ❖ In situations like this it is important to ascertain first whether or not a respondent fits into the category about which you are enquiring.

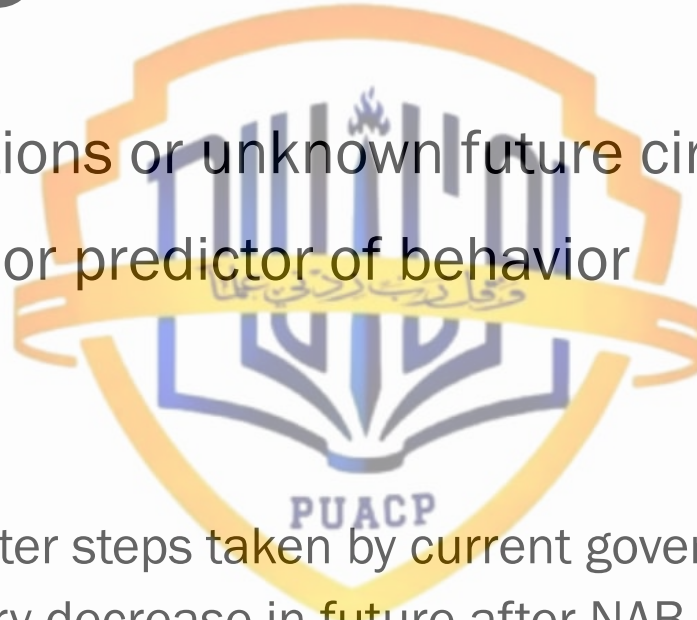


AVOID ASKING ABOUT FUTURE INTENTIONS

- ❖ Do not ask future questions or unknown future circumstances.
- ❖ Respondents can be poor predictor of behavior

For example

- ❖ Will inflation rate decline after steps taken by current government.
- ❖ Will corruption in our country decrease in future after NAB actions?



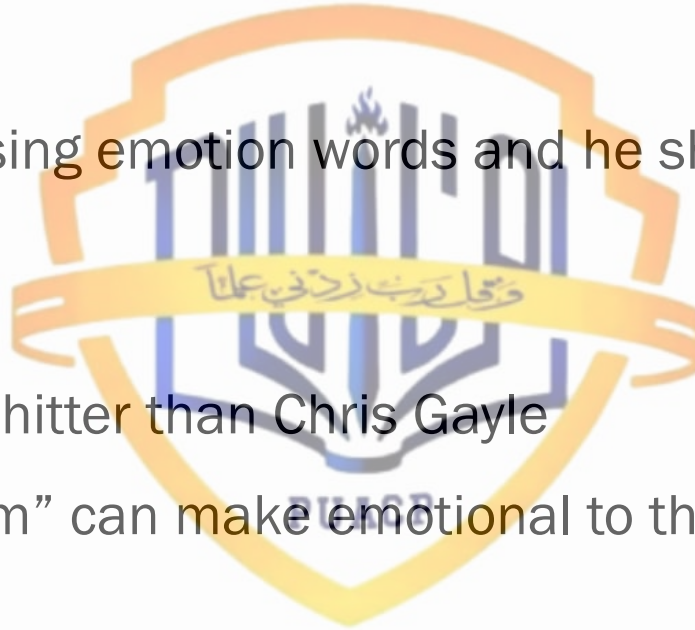
AVOID EMOTIONAL LANGUAGE

Researcher should avoid using emotion words and he should use the neutral words.

For example

Boom Boom Afridi is better hitter than Chris Gayle

Using the word “Boom Boom” can make emotional to the public of Pakistan.



THANKS

